

A definition:

Demand is the willingness and ability to buy a range of quantities of a good at a range of prices, during a given time.

Three points:

- *Willingness and ability.*
- *Range of quantities and prices.*
- *A given time period.*

8.3.4 Notes of Roger A. McCain

<http://william-king.www.drexel.edu/top/prin/txt/EcoToC.html>

If you are looking for ready-made notes, your search ends here. The site lists 39 chapters on the essential principals of economics, with a few chapters still to be written.

The chapters that have been written, are done so as notes so that they can be referred to while studying that particular topic.

Excerpts***Surplus-Value***

So Marx addressed the question: if value is socially necessary labour time, so that labour produces all value, why does the market award incomes to people who do not work? His key insight was:

In a competitive capitalist economy, all commodities are priced at their values.

In a competitive capitalist economy, labour is a commodity.

Therefore, in a competitive capitalist economy, labour is priced at its value.

In other words: the wage paid for a labour-day would be the labour time socially necessary to produce the Labour Day. Suppose that it takes just half of a labour day to produce a labour day. Then workers will always be available for half a labour-day of pay, and employers, knowing this, will pay no more than half a labour-day of wages per labour-day. Half a Labour Day is left to the employers. It is “surplus-value” and is the source of profits, interest, and rent. Employers (and landowners and financiers) don’t have to do anything to get it—it is just “left over” after the competitive wage has been paid.